

Tool released to run more Linux distros on Windows

Microsoft has unveiled a tool to assist Linux distribution managers. The tool will help in bringing users' preferred Linux distros to operate on Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL). It is actually a compatibility layer for the functioning of Linux Binary executables on Windows 10.



In addition, the tool will also provide a compatible kernel interface proposed by Microsoft, which can then operate a GNU on top of it, including SUSE Linux Enterprise Server, Kali Linux, Ubuntu and open SUSE.

This Windows sub-system for Linux cannot run all kinds of Linux software. There are a number of Linux distros available, most of which are created for some particular niche purpose only. For instance, this kind of sub-system cannot run 32-bit binaries, or those needed for unimplemented kernel services.

The tool doesn't support a GUI as it is specifically designed to provide alternative command line interfaces to Windows tools. Also, developers can't share the Linux distributions on the Microsoft store. They can initially use the tool to create its packages that can be added into a machine operating Windows 10 in developer mode.

The WSL is only accessible on x64 editions of Windows10, and can be run on the advanced version of Windows 10 or later. Earlier, Microsoft decided to open source a project called 'WSL DistroLauncher Sample' that includes a reference execution of how Linux OS projects could implement their Linux distro to work inside the WSL component.

By releasing it as open source, the toolset code will now be available for researchers in industry, government and academia. They will be able to freely



use, modify and customise it while developing carbon capture and other related technologies.

The major capabilities of the CCSI toolset include rapid computational screening. This will enable the comprehensive screening and evaluation of promising concepts at all scales (molecular

through system-level) with a full understanding of the underlying uncertainty and its spread throughout multi-scale analyses.

Post the open source release, the CCSI toolset will reduce the time needed to design and troubleshoot new devices and processes by using optimisation techniques that focus on technology development. These models also help to maximise learning during each stage of the development process, from the laboratory to pilot, till demonstration and commercialisation.

Service Fabric is going open source

Microsoft has officially blogged that the company is open sourcing Service Fabric under the MIT licence in the coming months, when it will transition to an open development process on GitHub.

Service Fabric, first known as Windows Fabric, is Microsoft's Azure Platform-as-a-Service 2.0 microservices platform. It also competes to some degree with



Kubernetes, as both platforms can act as orchestrators by packaging, deploying and maintaining applications and containers.

Microsoft officials have referred to Service Fabric as its 'secret sauce', and use it internally to run pieces of the Azure core, Skype for Business, Intune, Event Hubs, Azure SQL DB, Cosmos DB, Cortana and more. Microsoft has made available Service Fabric for Windows, Linux, Windows Server and for Linux in Azure. As of now, you can compile and test Service Fabric for Linux — everything from the low-level clustering and federation layers all the way up to process and container activation.

The blog also stated that Microsoft will be opening up Service Fabric for contributions from the community, in the near future.

The Linux version of the Service Fabric repo and related build and test tools are available on GitHub, allowing interested parties to run basic tests, open issues and submit pull requests. Microsoft is working on getting the Windows version migrated to GitHub too, according to its blog post. Over the past year, Microsoft has open sourced various pieces of Service Fabric, including Reliable Services, Reliable Actors and its ASP.NET Core integration libraries. Microsoft's plan is to open source its entire runtime, plus a build environment for Linux and Windows.

Microsoft has, of late, been open sourcing a lot of its software, services and even its documentation.

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